

Required practical: Preparing a pure, dry sample of a salt from an insoluble oxide or carbonate

C4 Chemical Changes



Queen
Elizabeth
School

Title - Making Salt Required Practical Write Up

Questions

1. Explain why an excess of the solid is added to the acid.

2. Explain why the solution that has been filtered needs to be concentrated by heating a little.

Answers

If the solid is in excess, all of the acid will have reacted and totally converted into the soluble salt. Also, if some acid was unreacted, it would contaminate the salt solution. The excess solid is easy to filter off.

It is heated to make the salt solution more concentrated. This means that the crystals form more effectively (saturated solution).

Title - Making Salt Required Practical Write Up

Put the following steps for making salt in the correct order:

A. The concentrate is left to cool and crystallise to produce a solid salt.

B. The excess solid is filtered off leaving a solution of the salt.

C. The salt solution is then heated a little to concentrate it.

D. The solid is added to the acid until no more of the solid reacts and it is in excess.

Which salts can be made?

Copy and complete the equations below:

Metal + acid $\rightarrow$ _____ + Hydrogen

Metal oxide + acid $\rightarrow$ _____ + water

Metal hydroxide + _____ $\rightarrow$ metal salt + water

Metal carbonate + acid $\rightarrow$ metal salt + _____ + _____

Forming ions:

Metals:

Magnesium Mg^{2+}

Iron Fe^{2+}

Zinc Zn^{2+}

Acids:

Sulfuric acid H_2SO_4 SO_4^{2-}

Hydrochloric acid HCl Cl^-

Nitric acid HNO_3 NO_3^-

Forming ions:

- When determining the compound formed, the charges of the cation and anion must be equal
- Mg^{2+} and SO_4^{2-} have opposite and equal charges and so form MgSO_4

Forming ions:

- What will happen with Mg^{2+} and Cl^- ?

Title – Neutralisation

Forming ions:

- What will the chemical formula be with Zn^{2+} and NO_3^- ?
- What will the chemical formula be with Na^+ and Cl^- ?
- What will the chemical formula be with Fe^{2+} and SO_4^{2-} ?

Alkalis and bases

Metal oxides and metal hydroxides are **bases**.

Some bases are soluble in water, and these are called **alkalis**,

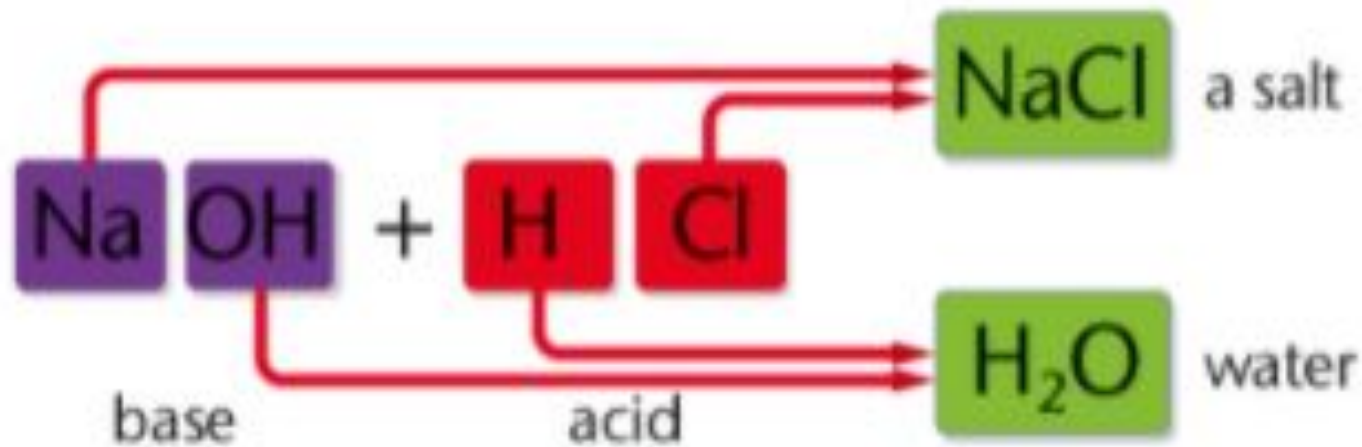
When an acid and a base react, *neutralisation* takes place to make a **salt** and water.

The word equation for neutralisation is:



The reaction of sodium hydroxide, a soluble base, with hydrochloric acid produces sodium chloride.

sodium hydroxide + hydrochloric acid $\rightarrow$ sodium chloride + water



We do

Write the word equation for the reaction between potassium hydroxide and hydrochloric acid.

acid + base → salt + water

Answer

Potassium hydroxide + Hydrochloric acid 

Potassium chloride + water

You do

1) **Write the word equation for the reaction between sodium hydroxide and hydrochloric acid.**

acid + base → salt + water

Sodium hydroxide + Hydrochloric acid  Sodium chloride + Water

Salts can also be made by reacting acids with excess of an insoluble base.

For example, zinc oxide is an insoluble base. Zinc oxide and sulfuric acid react to make zinc sulfate and water.

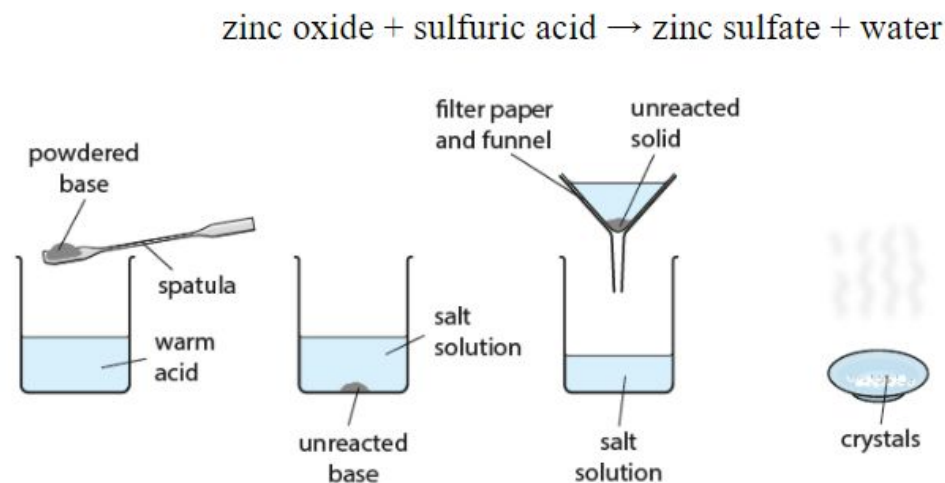


Figure 4.28 Making a salt with excess base or carbonate

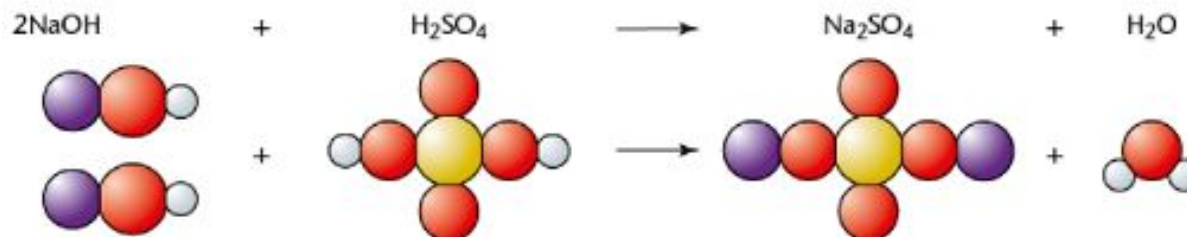
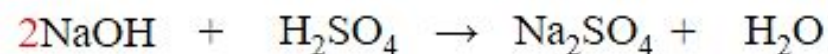
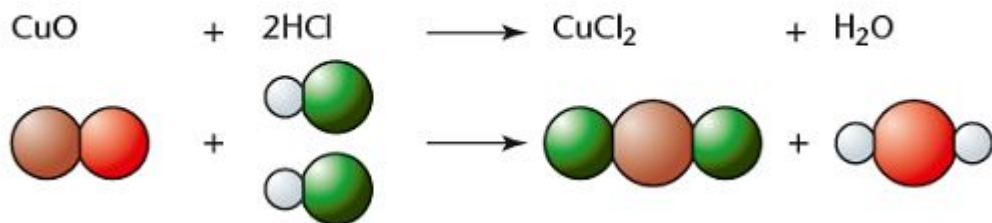
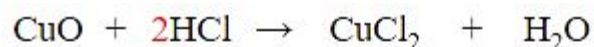
Common chemical compounds

Acids		Bases and alkalis		Carbonates		Metals	
sulfuric acid	H_2SO_4	potassium hydroxide	KOH	sodium carbonate	Na_2CO_3	magnesium	Mg
nitric acid	HNO_3	sodium hydroxide	NaOH	calcium carbonate	CaCO_3	zinc	Zn
hydrochloric acid	HCl	calcium hydroxide	$\text{Ca}(\text{OH})_2$	zinc carbonate	ZnCO_3	iron	Fe
		copper oxide	CuO	copper carbonate	CuCO_3		

Charges on ions

Salts are formed using ions with +2 and -1 charge (e.g. copper chloride CuCl_2) or using ions with +1 and -2 charge (e.g. sodium sulfate Na_2SO_4), the equations will need to be balanced.

Single charge	Cl^-	NO_3^-	OH^-	Na^+	K^+	H^+
Double charge	SO_4^{2-}	Ca^{2+}	Mg^{2+}	Zn^{2+}	Fe^{2+}	Cu^{2+}



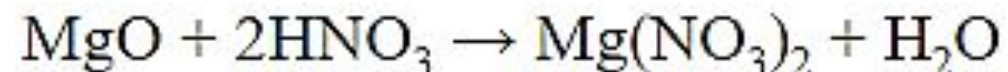
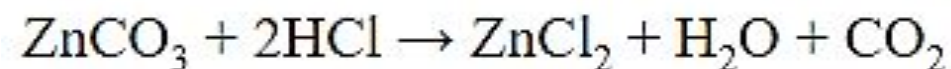
Charges on ions

Questions

1. Write a balanced equation for the reaction between zinc carbonate and hydrochloric acid.

2. Write a balanced equation for the reaction between magnesium oxide and nitric acid.

Answers



Solubility simulation

Extended investigation of soluble salts:

<https://phet.colorado.edu/sims/cheerpi/soluble-salts/latest/soluble-salts.html?simulation=soluble-salts>

The screenshot shows the 'Salts & Solubility (1.08)' simulation window. The interface includes a menu bar with 'File' and 'Help', and a tabbed navigation system with 'Table Salt', 'Slightly Soluble Salts', and 'Design a Salt'. The main area displays a rectangular tank with a faucet on the left and a cylindrical container above it. The tank is filled with a blue liquid and contains numerous small green and red spheres representing ions. A vertical scale on the right side of the tank ranges from 1.0×10^{-23} L to 8.0×10^{-23} L. On the right side of the window, there is a control panel for 'Salt' and 'Water'. The 'Salt' section has a legend for 'Sodium' (red dot) and 'Chloride' (green dot), and input fields for 'Dissolved', 'Bound', and 'Total' ions, each with a value of 86. The 'Water' section has a 'Volume' input field set to 5.00×10^{-23} liters (L) and a 'Reset All' button.

Specification link

4.4.2.3 Soluble salts

Content	Key opportunities for skills development
Soluble salts can be made from acids by reacting them with solid insoluble substances, such as metals, metal oxides, hydroxides or carbonates. The solid is added to the acid until no more reacts and the excess solid is filtered off to produce a solution of the salt. Salt solutions can be crystallised to produce solid salts. Students should be able to describe how to make pure, dry samples of named soluble salts from information provided.	

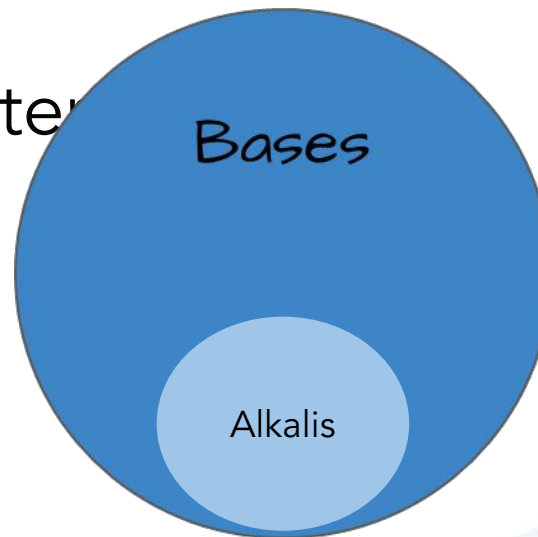
Required practical 1: preparation of a pure, dry sample of a soluble salt from an insoluble oxide or carbonate using a Bunsen burner to heat dilute acid and a water bath or electric heater to evaporate the solution.

AT skills covered by this practical activity: 2, 3, 4 and 6.

This practical activity also provides opportunities to develop WS and MS. Details of all skills are given in [Key opportunities for skills development](#).

Bases and alkalis

- We can also use bases and alkalis to neutralise acids and produce salts. - you did it this morning when you brushed your teeth!
- Bases are ionic compounds that can neutralise acids
- Most bases are insoluble in water
- Alkalis are soluble bases



Making soluble salts

Soluble salts can be made by reacting acids with either soluble or insoluble bases.

Making a salt from an alkali

If you are using an alkali - which is a soluble base - then you need to add just enough acid to make a neutral solution (check a small sample with universal indicator paper).

Warm the salt solution to evaporate the water. You get larger crystals if you evaporate the water slowly.

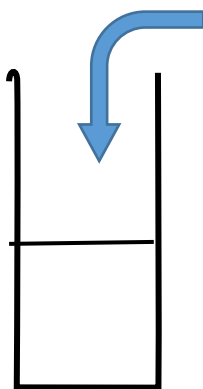
Making a salt from an insoluble metal oxide or carbonate

Copper oxide and other transition metal oxides or hydroxides do not dissolve in water. If the base is insoluble, then an extra step is needed to form a salt.

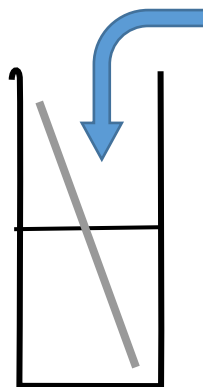
You add the base to the warm acid until no more will dissolve and you have some base left over – this is called an ‘excess’. You filter the mixture to remove the excess base, and then evaporate the water in the filtrate to leave the salt behind.

Key questions

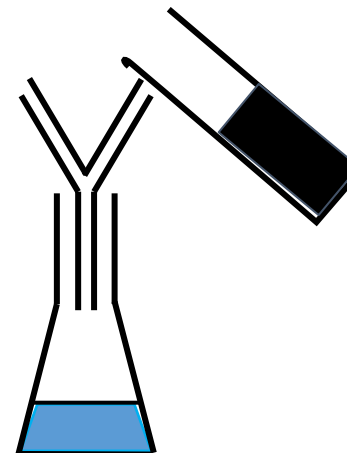
1. What is meant by the filtrate?
2. What is meant by the residue?
3. What is the filtrate in this experiment?
4. What is the residue in this experiment?
5. Why is a water bath used to evaporate the water from the copper sulphate solution instead of heating the evaporating basin directly with a Bunsen burner?
6. Why should you not evaporate all of the water from the copper sulphate solution?



1. Add 20cm³ sulphuric acid to a beaker.
The acid is in a water bath - why?

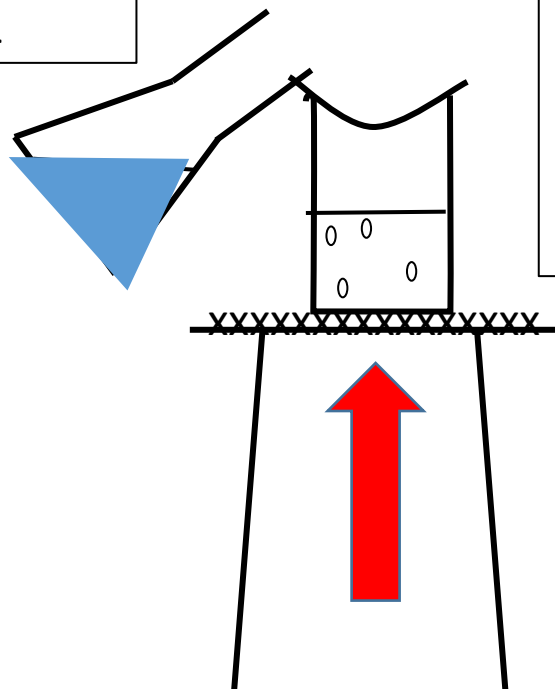


2. Add the copper oxide and stir until it is in **excess** - how can you tell? Why do we need to do this?



3. Filter the copper sulphate solution.

4. Pour the filtered solution into an evaporating dish.



5. Set up your equipment as shown in the diagram. Your evaporating dish needs to be on top of a half filled **beaker of water** - why?

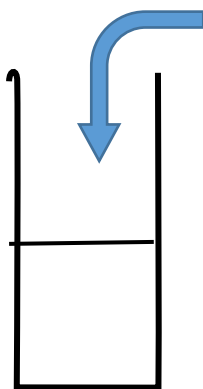
Evaporate gently until the copper sulphate solution has **halved**.

6. Leave to crystallise.

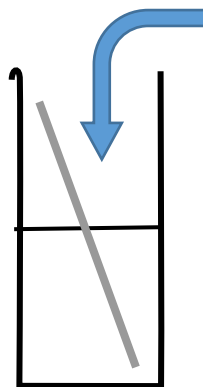


Questions

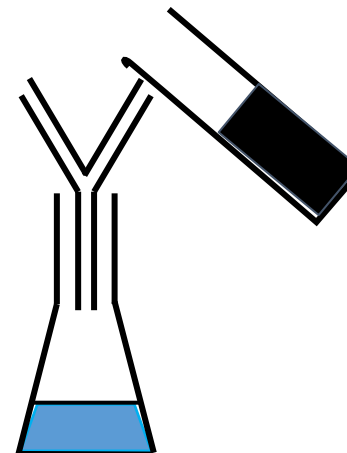
1. Write a balanced symbol equation for the reaction.
2. Why don't we see bubbles?
3. Write an ionic equation for the reaction.



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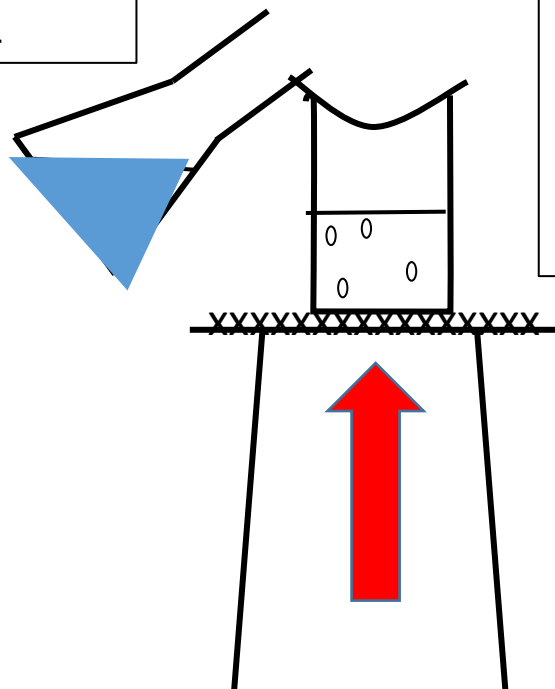


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Evaporate gently until the copper sulphate solution has **halved**.

6. Leave to crystallise.



Questions

1. Write a balanced symbol equation for the reaction.
2. Why don't we see bubbles?
3. Write an ionic equation for the reaction.

Conclusion

1. What safety precautions should you take when carrying out this experiment and why?
2. Why was it necessary to warm the sulphuric acid?
3. What colour was the copper sulphate solution that formed?
4. Why was it necessary to add copper oxide until it was present in excess?
5. How did you know when the copper oxide was present in excess?
6. How did you separate the excess copper oxide from the copper sulphate solution?

Conclusion

1. What safety precautions should you take when carrying out this experiment and why?
2. Why was it necessary to warm the sulphuric acid?
3. What colour was the copper sulphate solution that formed?
4. Why was it necessary to add copper oxide until it was present in excess?
5. How did you know when the copper oxide was present in excess?
6. How did you separate the excess copper oxide from the copper sulphate solution?

Answers – self mark

1. Balanced symbol: $\text{CuO}_{(s)} + \text{H}_2\text{SO}_{4(aq)} \rightarrow \text{CuSO}_{4(aq)} + \text{H}_2\text{O}_{(l)}$

2. Neither product is a gas.

3. Ionic: $\text{O}^{2-} + 2\text{H}^+ \rightarrow \text{H}_2\text{O}_{(l)}$

Correct the mistakes

To prepare crystals of copper sulphate the method is as follows. Add nickel oxide to sulphuric hydroxide with gentle cooling until no more will dissolve. Distil the mixture to remove unreacted copper oxide. Pour the filtrate into an evacuating basin and heat the solution until crystals just start to disappear. Allow to warm to room temperature and leave to evaporate quickly to obtain red crystals of copper chloride.

CONSOLIDATION

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To prepare crystals of copper sulphate the method is as follows. Add **copper** oxide to sulphuric **acid** with gentle **warming** until no more will dissolve. **Filter** the mixture to remove unreacted copper oxide. Pour the filtrate into an **evaporating** basin and heat the solution until crystals just start to **appear**. Allow to **cool** to room temperature and leave to evaporate **slowly** to obtain **blue** crystals of copper (

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CONSOLIDATION

Exam question

- (d) Describe how crystals of calcium chloride can be made from calcium carbonate and dilute hydrochloric acid.

Always
start by
writing
out the
word
equation
first!

Self-mark in green pen

(d) Describe how crystals of calcium chloride can be made from calcium carbonate and dilute hydrochloric acid.

(d) add excess calcium carbonate to acid (and stir) / add CaCO_3 until fizzing stops

ignore heating the acid

accept answer using calcium oxide in place of calcium carbonate

1

(remove excess calcium carbonate by) filter(ing)

1

warm until a saturated solution forms / point of crystallisation / crystals start to form

*do **not** accept heat until all water gone*

1

leave to cool

dependent on previous mark

*If solution **not** heated allow leave to evaporate (1)*

until crystals form (1)

1